Paper 4 — Islam in the modern world

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Independent notes mapped to sections 4.1–4.3 of the 2024–2026 syllabus. The guide distinguishes Islamic teachings, different interpretations, historical practice and contemporary law. None should be substituted uncritically for another.

1. Format and selected case-study route

90 minutes; 50 marks; choose **two essays from three**. Each essay is 25 marks: **AO1 knowledge/understanding 10, AO2 analysis/evaluation 15**, assessed within the essay, not separate (a)/(b) tasks. Questions can combine women, pluralism and leadership.

The named optional route used here is:

- Historical women at different times: **Razia of Delhi (thirteenth century)** and **Noor/Nur Jahan (sixteenth–seventeenth centuries)**.
- Recent/contemporary woman: **Benazir Bhutto**, with Malala as a brief optional education comparison. “Recent” does not require a living figure.
- Historical pluralism: **Muslim Spain**, not the alternative Akbar–Aurangzeb route.
- Two contemporary communities/countries: **Mauritius and France**. Both are Muslim-minority examples; the wider majority/minority comparison is also addressed below. The syllabus's examples are not compulsory country choices.
- Two reformers: **Muhammad Abduh and Muhammad Iqbal**.
- Recent political leader: **Mahathir Mohamad**, evaluated through documented past administrations, not unsupported claims about current

office.

Khadija, Aisha and Fatima are core early role models, not replacements for the two historical women and recent case. If your class studied different permitted examples, retain its depth and adapt the argument structures. This guide does not pretend to cover every optional biography.

Timing target: 5 minutes selecting/planning; 40 minutes each essay; 5 minutes checking. A workable essay has a precise introduction, several evidenced analytical paragraphs and a reasoned conclusion; there is no official fixed paragraph or word count.

2. Section 4.1 — women: teachings, rights and modern debate

Start with distinctions that prevent weak essays

Equal spiritual worth is not automatically the same proposition as **identical legal rules**, **equal access in practice**, or **identical social roles**. An answer should say which kind of equality it is assessing. Muslim women are not one uniform group: class, education, citizenship, family, disability and local law affect experience.

Qur'an 33:35 addresses believing men and women in parallel moral categories. Qur'an 9:71 describes believing men and women as allies supporting what is right. Qur'an 4:7 recognises women's inheritance entitlement. Qur'an 4:4 concerns the marriage gift (mahr) owed to women. These support agency and rights, but each must be explained in context rather than used to deny every difference in jurisprudence.

Early Islam challenged harmful practices such as female infanticide (81:8–9), recognised property/inheritance rights, and gave women religious and moral responsibility. Avoid a universal claim that every pre-Islamic woman everywhere had no property or influence: Khadija herself is a counterexample to that simplistic claim.

Family, marriage and different Muslim views

Marriage creates mutual responsibilities. Mahr belongs to the wife, not her family. Consent, fair treatment and protection from harm matter. Jurists differ on guardianship, divorce procedure and the distribution of family obligations. Classical accounts often connect a husband's maintenance duty with particular family roles; contemporary reformist readings emphasise reciprocity and shared decision-making in changed economic circumstances.

Qur'an 4:34 is interpreted differently concerning responsibility and authority; do not present one interpretation as the sole Muslim position. Explain the reasoning: some understand differentiated duties as complementary, others argue that equal capability and financial contribution support less hierarchical arrangements. Neither forced marriage nor domestic abuse becomes justified by calling it “culture”. Where discussing legal change, specify the jurisdiction instead of saying all Muslim countries have one law.

AO2 move: a right in a text may be undermined by poverty, lack of legal access or coercive custom. Conversely, a difficulty faced by one woman does not establish that Islam itself denies the relevant right. Distinguish normative entitlement from implementation.

Dress, modesty and social relationships

Qur'an 24:30 addresses men's gaze and modesty; 24:31 addresses women's modesty and covering; 33:59 is used in discussion of outer garments and public recognition. Many Muslims understand head-covering as a religious obligation; others stress the breadth and historical context of modest conduct or debate the precise covering required. Discuss differences respectfully and accurately.

Hijab can express devotion, identity and agency. Women may experience confidence or solidarity through it. Others face family/state coercion to wear it, or discrimination because they choose it. A woman who does not cover her hair should not be dismissed as incapable of moral agency or learning.

Protection question: explain the theological/ethical argument, then test the empirical claim. Modest dress is not a guarantee against assault, and harassment is the perpetrator's responsibility. Visibility can also expose women to anti-Muslim prejudice. June 2026 Q2 and its scheme explicitly permit critical discussion of that difference between modesty and guaranteed safety.

Education, careers and discrimination

Aisha's teaching and Khadija's business activity supply early evidence that learning and public contribution need not be incompatible with faith. Women can serve communities through education, healthcare, business, scholarship, public service and family care. Avoid reducing all women to supposedly natural “caring professions”.

Different views may prioritise household responsibilities, shared family obligations, economic necessity or equal opportunity. Evaluate the actual trade-off: unpaid care is valuable, but using it to exclude women from education or all public influence is a further claim needing justification. Flexible work, affordable childcare and shared responsibility can change what is possible.

Modern challenges: unequal schooling, discriminatory recruitment, poverty, religious prejudice, harassment, restrictive laws and gender stereotypes. **Modern opportunities:** wider higher education, communications, representation and legal protection. Whether today is “harder” than the past depends on the woman, place and criterion; do not compare an idealised past with only the worst modern cases.

3. Early and historical women — evidence for argument

Khadija

Khadija was a businesswoman and the Prophet's first wife, an early believer who gave personal and material support to his mission. Use her to discuss enterprise, trust, partnership and the capacity to combine family and wider contribution. Her example undermines the assertion that paid work is intrinsically incompatible with Muslim womanhood.

Evaluation: her importance is religious as well as economic. Do not reduce her to wealth, or assume that her elite circumstances made every form of participation equally accessible to all women. A role model supplies principles, not an identical career template.

Aisha

Aisha transmitted hadith and was a significant source of knowledge for the early community. Her teaching demonstrates women's contribution to religious knowledge, not merely secular schooling. Her public participation also raises questions of leadership and political disagreement.

Evaluation: distinguish authority as a scholar from uncritical endorsement of every political event. The Battle of the Camel belongs to a contested history; Sunni and Shi'a assessments differ. An answer on her modern relevance can uphold learning and questioning while recognising that modern institutions and conflict contexts differ. Avoid sectarian insult.

Fatima

Fatima, the Prophet's daughter, is revered for piety, closeness to the Prophet and family life; she has particular significance in Shi'a tradition as well as being honoured more widely. Her example supports devotion, ethical integrity and the value of family care.

Evaluation: valuing care does not prove that all women must have identical domestic roles. Different communities emphasise different aspects of her life; avoid treating contested succession narratives as

universally accepted facts. Compare her spiritual/family influence with Aisha's scholarly influence without inventing a competition in religious worth.

Historical woman 1 — Razia, Sultan of Delhi

Razia ruled Delhi from **1236 to 1240**. Her father Iltutmish nominated her as a successor; her accession and rule encountered powerful court opposition. She exercised sovereign responsibility, rather than merely influencing a husband behind the scenes. Georgetown University's Razia profile.

Use in an essay: a Muslim woman's actual exercise of political authority challenges an absolute historical claim that Muslim women never ruled. Opposition illustrates the interaction of gender expectations, elite interests and dynastic politics.

Limit: her short reign and eventual fall do not prove inherent female incapacity; men also faced violent succession conflicts. Conversely, one exceptional ruler does not establish equal access for ordinary women. Avoid the inaccurate universal title “first Muslim woman ruler”: earlier women exercised rule in other regions.

Historical woman 2 — Noor Jahan

Noor Jahan (1577–1645), wife of Mughal emperor Jahangir, exercised substantial political influence after their marriage in 1611. Coins bearing her name and the issuing of decrees provide concrete evidence of authority beyond ceremonial status. Her patronage included the tomb of Itimad-ud-Daulah. Britannica, Nur Jahan.

Compare with Razia: Razia held the sultanate in her own right; Noor Jahan operated through the Mughal court as empress consort with unusually extensive power. Both demonstrate agency but their institutional routes differed. Court status and family networks were resources unavailable to most women.

Judgement: historical significance should be assessed through actual decisions, influence and legacy, not just a famous name or the fact of being a woman.

Recent woman — Benazir Bhutto

Bhutto served as prime minister of Pakistan in **1988–1990 and 1993–1996**. She was the first woman to head a modern Muslim-majority national government. Her education, elected office and public leadership provide evidence for participation and the possibility of combining a Muslim identity with political responsibility. Britannica, Benazir Bhutto.

Her administrations faced military/presidential constraints, political opposition, instability and corruption allegations. These must be handled carefully: allegations, overturned judgements and established findings are not interchangeable. Her political record cannot be evaluated solely by gender. A balanced answer can assess representation and social initiatives alongside institutional limits and contested governance.

Religious-values question: compare justice, service, trust and consultation with concrete political conduct. Holding office does not automatically violate faith, but neither does identifying as Muslim prove that every decision meets Islamic standards.

Optional education contrast: Malala Yousafzai's advocacy for girls' schooling offers a campaigning rather than state-office model. If using her as your main contemporary case, research her actual work and impact, not just her survival or fame. A campaigning case is less directly suited than Bhutto to a question specifically requiring political office.

Debate: can women be political leaders?

A restrictive position cites the report concerning a people entrusting rule to a woman (Sahih al-Bukhari 7099), traditionally applied by some jurists to supreme political leadership. An alternative contextual reading relates it to the Persian political situation and does not treat it as a universal ban on every public office. Other arguments stress competence, justice, consultation, Qur'anic moral agency and the account of the Queen of Sheba in Qur'an 27.

Do not claim unanimity in either direction. Distinguish head of state, parliamentary representative, judge, scholar and community organiser. The existence of women rulers shows historical possibility but does not

alone resolve every legal interpretation. A reasoned judgement should state how it weighs textual interpretation, office type, capability and public benefit.

4. Section 4.2 — pluralism: principles and historical practice

Define the disputed term

Social/civic pluralism: people of different faiths live together with recognised rights and cooperation. **Theological pluralism:** claims about the truth or salvation status of different religions. A Muslim may maintain Islam's truth claims while supporting fair treatment and civic protection for others. Do not assume respect requires declaring all doctrines identical.

Qur'an 2:256 rejects compulsion; 60:8 supports kindness and justice toward those not fighting or expelling Muslims; 49:13 presents human diversity as a basis for knowing one another. Qur'an 5:8 requires justice even where dislike exists. Quotations strengthen an answer when their application is explained, not merely attached as decoration.

Medina and the early community

The arrangements associated with the Constitution/Charter of Medina illustrate cooperation and differentiated religious identity within a wider political community. Agreements concerned security, responsibilities and the management of relations among groups. They were not identical to a modern secular nation-state constitution or an unconditional absence of conflict.

The Prophet's relations with non-Muslims included treaties, trade, dialogue and conflict in particular circumstances. An argument should distinguish peaceful neighbours from wartime enemies rather than generalise every incident into a rule about all non-Muslims.

Umar and protected communities

Traditions about Umar's assurance to Jerusalem emphasise protection of lives, property and places of worship. The dhimmi framework generally recognised protected non-Muslim communities in exchange for obligations including jizya, while legal status could differ from Muslims'. Historical protection and modern equal citizenship are related questions but not identical concepts.

Source caution: the later document usually called the “Pact of Umar” should not simply be assumed to be a verbatim text personally authored by Umar I. Its transmission and historical application require care. Evaluate principles and documented practice, not a single idealised story.

Different Muslim views today: some favour retaining classical differentiated arrangements; others argue that modern citizenship and shared taxation can fulfil protection/justice without reproducing medieval status categories. Explain the reasoning and effects on people, rather than merely label one side “modern” and the other “backward”.

Historical case — Muslim Spain

Prepare change over time. Under some rulers, Jews and Christians participated in commerce, scholarship and public life; Córdoba's intellectual environment and Arabic scholarship demonstrate exchange. Protected status offered space for religious life, yet did not constitute modern equal citizenship.

Later regimes and conflicts brought serious limits and persecution, including under the Almohads. Maimonides illustrates why the region cannot be described as uniformly tolerant across all centuries. “Convivencia” is a useful term for coexistence but not proof that prejudice and violence disappeared.

AO2: assess protection, access to learning, freedom of worship and political power separately. A period may be strong on intellectual exchange yet unequal in formal status. The strongest historical judgement names a period or group and recognises variation.

This is the chosen alternative to Akbar/Aurangzeb. Do not use a few unprepared Mughal slogans if a question allows the Spanish route you know well. June 2026 Q3 explicitly permitted either route.

5. Contemporary pluralism — two case studies

Mauritius: protected freedom and everyday negotiation

Muslims form a minority within a religiously diverse population. **Section 11 of the Constitution** protects freedom of conscience, including religion, changing belief and manifestation/propagation through worship, teaching, practice and observance, subject to the section's lawful limitations. This is a concrete legal basis for discussing prayer, religious education and da'wah. Government-hosted Constitution.

Use as evidence of the legal framework, not proof that every person experiences zero prejudice. Daily negotiation can involve working hours and Friday prayer, fasting, religious festivals, school commitments and access to facilities. State which of these are reasoned examples of possible practical needs rather than invented documented incidents or guaranteed legal exemptions.

Muslims can contribute through lawful civic participation, professional work, charity, dialogue and good neighbourliness. Cooperation on poverty or environmental protection need not erase belief differences. Challenge the assumption that being a minority means political passivity or that da'wah must take an aggressive form.

France: citizenship, secular institutions and visible religion

France provides freedom of conscience and civic participation within a laïcité framework. Distinguish settings accurately:

- The **2004 law** restricts conspicuous religious symbols for pupils in state primary/secondary schools. It is not a blanket national ban on every headscarf everywhere.

- The **2010 law** concerns concealing the face in public space, subject to legal exceptions. It must not be confused with an ordinary hair-covering hijab.
- A state-school pupil, university student, public employee and person walking in the street are not the same legal category.

Research article on the two laws. These established examples are used here rather than unverified claims about every legal change in 2026. Check current official guidance before relying on a specific disputed new restriction.

Two viewpoints: supporters of institutional neutrality argue that common rules protect pupils from religious pressure and preserve a shared civic space. Critics argue restrictions can burden religious expression, constrain education choices and disproportionately affect visibly Muslim women. Evaluate proportionality and outcomes, not the stereotype that all French people oppose Islam.

Direct comparison and wider majority context

Mauritius and France both allow Muslim participation as minorities, but constitutional protection and institutional approaches to visible religion differ. In both, legal recognition is not the same as effortless accommodation in every workplace. A strong comparison examines the same issue in both settings: worship, dress, schooling, participation or dialogue.

In Muslim-majority contexts, Muslims may have easier access to mosques, halal food and public religious calendars, yet non-Muslim citizens may face questions about worship, conversion, family law and political eligibility. Majority status does not guarantee that a state follows Islamic justice; minority status does not automatically prevent authentic practice. Avoid treating all Muslim-majority states as having one uniform legal system.

Freedom of thought, belief and expression

Discuss both rights and contested limits. Freedom from coerced belief is not identical to unrestricted speech about every subject. Some Muslims emphasise restrictions concerning blasphemy or apostasy; others distinguish private conscience from treason/violence and argue for wider freedom under Qur'anic non-compulsion and justice. Acknowledge genuine disagreement and legal diversity.

Separate criticism of beliefs from incitement or harassment of people. Peaceful disagreement, evidence-based dialogue and lawful civic action can be defended without claiming an unlimited right to threaten others. Evaluate the principle reciprocally: the protections Muslims want as a minority should inform treatment of minorities where Muslims hold power.

Da'wah and interfaith cooperation

Minority circumstances may bring restrictions on proselytising, prejudice or practical barriers, but ethical example, open discussion and community service may remain possible. Qur'an 16:125 supports wise invitation; 2:256 rules out coercion. Cooperation on food poverty or disaster relief need not be conditional on conversion.

Judge a method by consent, accuracy, trust and context. A confrontational debate may generate attention but damage relations; a quiet charitable partnership may build trust while leaving detailed theology unexplained. Do not measure success only by numbers converting.

6. Section 4.3 — leadership: principles and institutions

Qualities, eligibility and responsibilities

A Muslim leader may hold political, religious or community authority; define which. Core qualities include justice, trustworthiness, knowledge, competence, consultation, compassion and accountability. Qur'an 4:58 connects public trust and justice; 4:135 insists on justice even against personal interests; 3:159 and 42:38 support consultation.

Responsibilities include welfare, security, fair judgement, protection of vulnerable people and restraint of corruption/oppression. Personal devotion matters, but piety alone is not evidence of administrative competence. Equally, economic skill without justice is not a sufficient Islamic standard.

Eligibility debates: classical views on gender, religious affiliation and supreme leadership vary in their relation to different offices and contemporary constitutions. Do not infer that every civil-service role has the same religious qualification as a classical caliphate. Ask what authority the office actually exercises and over whom.

Medina compared with pre-Islamic shaykh leadership

The tribal shaykh depended on kinship, prestige and negotiation among tribal groups. Prophetic leadership in Medina joined moral/religious authority with wider community organisation, agreements and adjudication across groups. It offered a basis of loyalty broader than lineage, while consultation and negotiated obligations remained important.

Do not claim consultation was invented from nothing in Medina or that pre-Islamic society had no moral obligations. The relevant comparison is how authority, belonging and responsibility were reoriented through Islam.

Four Rightly Guided Caliphs and democracy/shura

- **Abu Bakr:** accession involved consultation and allegiance, not a modern universal ballot.
- **Umar:** nominated by Abu Bakr and accepted by the community; his administration is useful for justice/accountability and welfare examples.
- **Uthman:** selected through a consultative council process; later opposition shows that selection alone does not prevent governance conflict.
- **Ali:** allegiance occurred amid severe division and civil conflict; do not portray the period as a frictionless ideal democracy.

The varying selection processes show no single modern electoral procedure simply copied across all four successions. **Shura** is a principle of

consultation; democracy includes particular institutions such as elections, representation and checks on government. Many Muslims regard such mechanisms as ways to realise consultation/accountability; others argue that unrestricted popular sovereignty could contradict divine law.

Judgement: distinguish moral principles from institutional forms. A government calling itself Islamic is not thereby accountable; a ballot alone does not establish justice. Explain which democratic features support Islamic aims and what limits different views propose.

Obedience, criticism and citizens' duties

Qur'an 4:59 is central to discussion of obedience and authority. In hadith, obedience is limited to what is right (e.g. Sahih al-Bukhari 7257), not commands to wrongdoing. Citizens' responsibilities can include lawful cooperation, paying legitimate dues, truthful advice and avoiding destructive disorder.

One argument prioritises stability and the danger of violence. Another stresses that unquestioning obedience enables corruption and violates moral accountability. Do not make the false choice “obey every abuse or endorse violence”: lawful criticism, courts, consultation, peaceful campaigning and elections are intermediate mechanisms. Evaluate context, consequences and moral limits.

7. Two reformers and a recent leader

Muhammad Abduh (1849–1905)

An Egyptian scholar and jurist, mufti of Egypt from 1899. He sought educational/legal reform and harmony between reason and Islamic faith, challenged unthinking imitation and supported engagement with modern knowledge. His Treatise on the Oneness of God is a useful named work. Britannica, Muhammad Abduh.

Contribution: curriculum and institutional reform can equip Muslims to respond to new circumstances without abandoning religious identity. **Evaluation:** reforms met resistance; critics can question how far reinterpretation preserves inherited legal authority. Avoid claiming he

abolished all tradition or made every modern innovation religiously acceptable.

Muhammad Iqbal (1877–1938)

A poet/philosopher associated with Muslim intellectual renewal in South Asia. **The Reconstruction of Religious Thought in Islam** and his account of **khudi** (selfhood/self-development) emphasise active moral agency, renewal and responsible engagement rather than passive decline. His thought supported ijtihad in confronting modern social/political problems. Britannica, Muhammad Iqbal.

Contribution: poetry and philosophy can motivate a broad community, connecting religious self-understanding with action. **Evaluation:** inspirational ideas require institutions and interpretation to become policy. Do not describe Iqbal as a prime minister of Pakistan or imply he lived to govern the state created in 1947.

Compare the reformers

Both sought renewal rather than simple abandonment of Islam; both made intellectual engagement important. Abduh worked more directly within legal/educational institutions in Egypt; Iqbal's poetry/philosophy shaped self-understanding and political imagination in South Asia. Compare method, audience and effect rather than claiming either single-handedly “modernised Islam”.

Recent leader — Mahathir Mohamad

Prime minister of Malaysia **1981–2003 and 2018–2020**. His governments are associated with industrialisation, foreign investment, infrastructure and economic development. The case allows evaluation of public welfare and competence in a multi-religious society. Britannica, Mahathir Mohamad.

A balanced answer also considers concentration of power and political conflict, including the dismissal/arrest of Anwar Ibrahim in 1998, rather than equating economic growth with complete Islamic justice. Evaluate through standards such as trust, accountability, consultation and fair treatment; do not turn religious identity into an automatic verdict on every

policy.

Evidence -> principle -> judgement: improved living standards can support a welfare argument; constraints on opposition raise accountability concerns. The question is how these considerations should be weighed, not whether one is allowed to notice only achievements or only failings. Distinguish documented events from a personal judgement about Islamic adequacy.

Faith versus competence

A faith-first argument holds that religious commitment guides decisions and moral accountability. A competence-first argument stresses the harm done by incapable leaders and the shared need for fair administration across faiths. A synthesis argues for demonstrable integrity AND ability, while allowing institutional checks because neither reputation nor claimed piety guarantees performance.

Differentiate spiritual authority over believers from political authority over a religiously diverse population. That distinction can change how relevant shared faith is to eligibility.

8. The crossover pages: use the same evidence differently

Influential woman versus leader

Compare Bhutto with Mahathir under identical criteria: access to authority, welfare aims, institutional constraints, public accountability and legacy. Do not write two unrelated biographies. Gender influenced Bhutto's symbolic significance and obstacles, but should not replace assessment of governance.

Leaders and other faiths

Connect Medina/Spain, Qur'an 60:8 and 5:8, then evaluate a leader's protection of worship, fair law and civic participation. Distinguish professed tolerance from actual outcomes. Security measures need proportionality rather than a blanket assumption that minorities are threats.

Women and faith-minority challenges

A Muslim woman in France may experience overlapping gender and visible-religion barriers. A non-Muslim woman in a Muslim-majority society may face different overlapping issues. Compare rights, access, coercion and representation without assuming the experiences are identical. Show how social location changes the effect of a general rule.

Past versus present

Stable values: justice, trust, welfare, consultation. Changed conditions: mass electorates, modern bureaucracy, international law, digital misinformation, complex economies. A nuanced conclusion can defend continuity of ethical standards while requiring new skills and institutions.

9. Evidence bank — learn meanings, not decorative quotations

All Qur'anic entries here are paraphrases. Use an accurate learnt translation or clearly signal a paraphrase.

- 33:35: parallel moral responsibility/reward of believing men and women -> spiritual worth.
- 9:71: believing women and men as allies -> participation and responsibility.
- 4:7 and 4:4: inheritance entitlement and mahr -> concrete rights, not proof of identical shares in every case.
- 24:30–31 and 33:59: modesty and covering -> interpretation, agency and reciprocal responsibilities.

- 2:256: no compulsion -> invitation is not forced conversion.
- 60:8 and 5:8: kindness/justice and justice despite dislike -> relations across faiths.
- 49:13: human diversity and knowing one another -> respect without doctrinal sameness.
- 4:58 and 4:135: trust and impartial justice -> standards for rulers and citizens.
- 3:159 and 42:38: consultation -> basis for discussing shura.
- 4:59 and Bukhari 7257: authority alongside moral limits on obedience.
- Bukhari 7099: a contested application in women-and-rule debate; explain interpretive disagreement.

10. Final syllabus checklist

- [ ] 4.1 rights, family/marriage, custom versus teaching, dress, relationships, careers and discrimination.
- [ ] 4.1 early changes, Khadija/Aisha/Fatima, two historical women at different times, one recent woman.
- [ ] 4.2 majority/minority rights, religious freedom/expression, everyday practice and interfaith relations.
- [ ] 4.2 Medina, Umar/dhimmi, historical alternative chosen, two contemporary communities compared.
- [ ] 4.3 qualities/eligibility, welfare/justice, corruption/oppression, citizens' duties and leadership settings.
- [ ] 4.3 Medina/shaykh, four caliphs, democracy/shura, two reformers and one recent leader evaluated.
- [ ] Crossovers: woman versus leader; leaders and other faiths; women/minority challenges.
- [ ] Two timed essays with evidence, alternative viewpoints and a justified conclusion.

11. Assessment references

June 2026 Paper 4 mark scheme; official June 2024 examiner report. Top AO2 work analyses the strength of competing views and assesses alternative conclusions. Disagreement must be argued fairly: no named country or gender is a substitute for evidence.